

AI4BCM Quick Start

Using artificial intelligence in
business continuity management

2026.11

For BCM professionals, their managers and the colleagues who work beside them.

AI prepares, people decide

Ask AI to prepare, compare, summarise, retrieve, and challenge. But require people to decide, approve, and act.

- 1 **Use only approved tools**, never free public ones.
- 2 **Base every answer** on approved sources.
- 3 **Have a person review output** before anyone relies on it.
- 4 **Let only people** approve, declare, invoke, accept risk or speak externally.
- 5 **Keep fallback methods** for essential BCM work.

Start with:

- drafting non-sensitive content
- summarising approved material
- preparing BIA interviews
- checking that plans agree
- extracting actions from debriefs



Plug this guidance into the AI tool you already use:
ai4bcm.org/plug-it-in

Check these eight points before every AI task

- ☐ the tool is approved for the type of data involved
- ☐ the information is suitable for that environment
- ☐ the task is narrow and clear
- ☐ the output is based on approved, current sources, citations checked
- ☐ the reviewer knows the subject, has the sources and the time, and knows who to pass it to if unsure
- ☐ any actions or record changes have approval gates
- ☐ you can show afterwards who did what, and from which sources
- ☐ fallback methods exist if the tool is unavailable

The more sensitive the data, the tighter the control: BIA, crisis, personal, supplier, recovery and security detail, board papers, open audit findings.

Some decisions never rest on AI alone

- formal approval or sign-off
- autonomous declaration of incidents or crises
- autonomous invocation of continuity plans
- unsupervised external communications
- statements to a regulator, auditor or certification body
- automatic risk acceptance
- uncontrolled amendment of BCM or BCMS records

Never acceptable, whoever approves it

- making up evidence, audit material or records
- replacing human welfare, ethical or safety judgement
- entering passwords, keys or access tokens into any tool

Start small, then grow one level at a time

A good first task passes four tests:

- Do you do it at least monthly?
- Would you rather not do it?
- Could a new colleague learn its steps in minutes?
- Can a person approve it, and work go on without the tool?



Level 1 • Ad hoc.

Start with low-risk tasks.



Level 2 • Repeatable.

Share tested prompts and review rules.



Level 3 • Defined.

Connect approved repositories once governance is ready.



Level 4 • Measured.

Test, and count quality and failures, before going live.



Level 5 • Optimising.

Extend on measured evidence, once governance is mature.

Levels 3 to 5 change systems and governance: there, experience counts.

Ask it, don't read it

- **Ask it** · ai4bcm.org/chat · reads: Nothing of yours
- **AI4BCM skills** · ai4bcm.org/plug-it-in · reads: Your files, in your approved environment
- **Plug it in** · ai4bcm.org/plug-it-in · reads: Nothing of yours

Type **/ask-ai4bcm** and your task in your AI tool: it finds the right skill, prompt and level.

The editors share their working method, pitfalls included, with BCM teams and the advisers who support them.

Konstantin Gerner, editor



This is the Quick Start of AI4BCM Guidance 2026.11.

The full guidance: ai4bcm.org/guidance. Plug it into your AI tool: ai4bcm.org/plug-it-in.

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